Level 4 Adult ESL Curriculum · Lesson 5 (Week 5): Would You Mind…?

Status: Complete lesson (all 13 Level 4 lessons are published).

Date: October 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and volunteer teachers

Companion files: images/ (12 vocabulary pictures + images/CREDITS.md). Audio: audio/L4_L5_listening.mp3.

> **Topic:** Asking a neighbor or coworker for a favor: getting the mail and watering the plants while you're away, a spare key, covering or switching a shift, and borrowing something. Learners ask with *Would you mind…?* and *Do you mind if I…?*, and say yes or no politely. All favors, keys, and addresses are invented.

How this lesson is organized

Part	What's inside	Who uses it
Teacher Plan	At a glance, clock-time plan, step-by-step boxes, listening script, answer key, teacher notes	Volunteer teachers
Student Pages	Opening Talk, New Words, My Words, Listening, Grammar, Talk Time, Homework, Read & Write, Exit Ticket, Task Words (optional). **Print this part for learners**	Learners
Picture Credits	Picture, audio, and license credits	Coordinators

What Lesson 5 builds on and what it adds

Before (review only)	Where	New in Level 4 Lesson 5
Can you…? / Could you…? for requests	Level 2	***Would you mind* + -ing** for bigger favors: *Would you mind getting my mail?*
I'd like to…	Level 3 Lesson 7	*I'd like to switch my Friday shift.* and permission: ***Do you mind if I…?***
will for offers; possessive pronouns	Level 3	*Sure, I'll do it.* • *Could I borrow **yours**?*

TEACHER PLAN

Lesson 5 (Week 5)

Would You Mind…?

At a glance · Clock-time plan · Step by step · Script and answer key

How to Use This Plan

You don't need to speak Spanish or any other language. Teach in English. Show, point, and gesture. Some Grammar pages have one short **contrast tip**, only where a common mix-up exists. Learners read it on their own. You never need to read, translate, or explain it.

Instructions: use the same short task words every week: *Listen. Circle. Check. Write. Work with a partner. Work in a group. Ask a follow-up question. Give a reason.* An optional Task Words page is at the back of the workbook for learners who want it.

Instruction rule: Model it (do it with one learner while everyone watches), **check it** (ask: "Is it a problem for you? If not, what do you say?"), **then go**. Say less, show more.

Grouping toolkit: *Pairs:* turn to a neighbor; with an odd number, make one group of 3. *Groups:* 3–4 learners. *Inside–outside circles:* the inner circle faces out, the outer circle faces in; the outer circle moves one person to the right each round. *Mingle:* everyone stands and talks to many classmates. The teacher joins a pair only if one learner is left over.

When a learner is stuck or speaks another language to you: (1) show it: the picture, a gesture, or the board; (2) give one more short English example; (3) point to the grammar box on their page; (4) a classmate can help for a few seconds, then back to English. You don't need to understand what classmates say to each other.

Three sentences, not one: in Level 4, every Talk Time answer and every exit ticket has about three connected sentences: the answer, a reason, and a detail or example.

Lesson 5 (Week 5): Would You Mind…?

At a glance

Objectives: learners can…

- ask for a favor with *Would you mind…?*
- answer *No, not at all* (= "Yes, I'll help") or say no politely, with a reason and another idea
- ask permission with *Do you mind if I…?*
- ask a coworker to switch a shift and confirm it in a short text
- write a note to a neighbor (5–8 sentences) asking for a favor while they're away

Materials

- Student Pages for Lesson 5 (print for the number expected + 3 spares)
- Board and markers
- Favor cards and "my week" cards (in the workbook Talk Time page; copy them onto index cards, optional)
- A key and an envelope (optional, for the warm-up)
- Listening: phone + small speaker, L4_L5_listening.mp3 (about 1:54). No speaker? Read the script aloud with a volunteer.
- **Prep time:** 15 minutes (read the plan; practice reading the listening script; practice the thumbs-up "No, not at all!").

Key vocabulary (with pictures on the New Words page)

★ favor • ★ borrow • ★ water the plants • ★ feed the cat • ★ get the mail • ★ spare key • ★ package • ★ switch shifts • ★ cover a shift • ★ be away • owe (someone) • thank-you note

Also: a neighbor, a coworker, lend, a ladder, a trip, a package room, a code, a text, ask the supervisor, I owe you one, go ahead.

Clock-time plan

Times are loose. If the listening or Talk Time runs long, take the time from Read & Write.

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:08	**Opening Talk + Homework Check**	8	Pairs (7 pairs + 1 trio / 3–4 pairs)	One card only
6:08–6:15	**New Words** (picture page) + pair game (+ My Words)	7	Whole class, then pairs	Teach the ★ words only
6:15–6:30	**Listening:** play 1 (Task A), play 2 (Tasks B and C) + "Hear it, say it"	15	Individuals, then pairs check	Do Task C together on the board
6:30–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** *Would you mind…? / Do you mind if I…?* + pair check	15	Whole class, then pairs	Skip the pair check; Talk Time practices it
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:15	**Talk Time: Favor Exchange + Shift Switch Text**	15	Mingle, then pairs	Round 1 only
7:15–7:25	**Read & Write:** A building notice + a neighbor's note; a note to a neighbor	10	Pairs read, then individual writing	Reading questions only; the writing becomes homework
7:25–7:30	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5	Individuals	**Never skip**

Skip order if you're running behind: (1) the Read & Write writing task (it becomes homework); (2) the pair check at the end of Grammar; (3) the second round of Talk Time. **Never skip:** the listening tasks, the grammar boxes and the mistakes table, and the exit ticket.

Attendance (15 → 7–8 → 5 or fewer): every step lists the sizes. With 5 or fewer, make a circle for Favor Exchange: each person asks the person on the left. Do the Shift Switch Text in pairs; you join if there is an odd number. Late arrivals join the mingle with a new favor card.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:08 · Opening Talk · 8 min

- **Grouping:** pairs, the same partner for both parts. 15 learners: 7 pairs + 1 group of 3. 7–8 learners: 3–4 pairs. 5 or fewer: pairs, or one group with you.
- **Before class:** write on the board: suggestions: *Why don't you…? / You could… / It's a good idea to…*
- **Opening Talk (5 min):** learners open the **Opening Talk** page. A asks a card question; B answers in **3 sentences** (the answer, a reason, a detail); A asks one follow-up. Switch after each card.
- **Model with one learner:** you say, "I sit all day at work. Any ideas?" The learner gives a suggestion. Then you ask, "Why is that a good idea?" Help them say 3 sentences.
- **Homework Check (3 min):** Pairs compare Homework item 1 (*for / since* and suggestions) and read their 3 good ideas (item 3) to each other. Then they fill in the box on the Opening Talk page. Walk around. Write **2** common errors on the board (often *You could to try* (→ *You could try*) and *I have a cough since Sunday* (→ *I've had a cough since Sunday*)) and correct them together. Also put up 2 corrections from last week's exit tickets.
- **Late arrivals:** join any pair as a group of 3.
- **If behind:** one card only.

Step 2 · 6:08–6:15 · New Words · 7 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs. Show the New Words page.
- **Do:** point to each picture and say the word. Learners repeat once.
- **Show the hard words:** *favor* (help you ask for); *borrow* (take and give back) vs. *lend* (give and get back); *water the plants*, *feed the cat*, *get the mail* (mime each); *spare key* (an extra key: show two keys); *package*; *switch shifts* (you take my Friday, I take your Sunday) vs. *cover a shift* (you work my shift); *be away* (not at home); *owe* (*I owe you one* = I'll help you next time); *thank-you note*.
- **Check meaning (1 min):** ask "If I borrow your pen, do I give it back?" (yes) • "If you cover my shift, who works?" (you do) • "Is a spare key the first key or an extra key?" (an extra key).
- **Pairs (2 min):** A says a word; B points to the picture and makes a sentence (Would you mind getting my mail? → No, not at all.). Switch. **15 learners:** finish with a quick team round (3 teams; you say a clue, the first team with the word gets a point). **7–8:** 2 teams. **5 or fewer:** one team against the clock.
- **My Words:** "Write any word you want in your language on the My Words page. It's your personal list. It's optional." Learners do it at home.
- **If behind:** teach the ★ words only.

Step 3 · 6:15–6:30 · Listening + "Hear it, say it" · 15 min

- **Grouping:** individuals, then pairs check. With 5 or fewer, check together as a group.
- **Before you listen (2 min):** say: "Patricia is going away for a week. First, she talks to her neighbor, Mr. Wilson. Then, at work, her coworker Omar asks her for a favor. Listen: what favors do they ask for?"
- **Play 1 → Task A** (the main idea). Pairs compare. Check together.
- **Read Tasks B and C together (1 min)** so learners know what to listen for.
- **Play 2 → Tasks B and C.** Pairs compare. Then show the answers (answer key).
- **"Hear it, say it" (3 min):** Point to the script lines. *gonna* = going to: "I'm **going to** be away next week." *wanna* = want to: "I **want to** help, but I can't." Then practice *Would you mind…?* and *Do you mind if I…?* said smoothly, with a friendly rise. The class repeats the two lines twice.
- **The audio plays the conversation once (about 1:54).** Press play again for play 2. A third play is fine if the class needs it. The script says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*; learners only need to recognize those words.
- **If behind:** do Task C together on the board, reading the lines yourself.

Step 4 · 6:30–6:45 · Grammar Q&A · 15 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs. Show the Grammar page. The **left side is the question. The right side is the answer.**
- **Show it (2 min):** give a learner your key. Say, "I'm going to be away. **Would you mind getting** my mail?" Show a thumbs-up and help the learner say, "**No, not at all.**" Write: *Would you mind + -ing? → No* = "No problem. I'll do it." Then ask, "**Do you mind if I open** the window?" Help them say, "No, go ahead."
- **The boxes (5 min):** Box 1: read across: *Would you mind getting my mail? → No, not at all. I'll do it. / Sorry, I can't.* Box 2: permission: *Do you mind if I…? → No, go ahead.* Box 3: saying yes and saying no politely. Box 4: how polite?
- **Rule of thumb and Questions and answers (2 min):** read the rule of thumb aloud. Read each Q and A; the class reads the right sentence after you.
- **Check questions:** "*Would you mind helping me?* You want to help. Do you say *yes* or *no*?" (*No, not at all.*) • "*Would you mind to get* or *getting*?" (*getting*) • "*Do you mind if I leaving* or *if I leave*?" (*if I leave*).
- **Practice A and B (3 min):** learners write, then pairs check. Go over the answers. Read the Common mistakes table together: "Don't say… Say…".
- **Pair check (last 3 min):** A asks a favor from the pictures with *Would you mind…?* B answers with a thumbs-up and *No, not at all*, or *Sorry, I can't, because…* Switch. **15 learners:** swap partners once. **5 or fewer:** you join one pair.
- **If behind:** skip the pair check. Talk Time practices it.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Write on the board: *Would you mind + -ing? → No, not at all. (= I'll help) / Sorry, I can't, because…* • *Do you mind if I…? → No, go ahead.*

Step 5 · 7:00–7:15 · Talk Time: Favor Exchange + Shift Switch Text · 15 min

- **Model it first (1 min):** hold up a favor card and ask a learner, "Would you mind getting my mail next week?" Help them check their "my week" card and answer, "No, not at all," or "Sorry, I can't, because I'll be away. Why don't you ask Ana?" Say: "Answer, give a reason, and offer an idea."
- **Round 1 (7 min): Favor Exchange (mingle).** Each learner has a favor card and a "my week" card. Ask three people. Each person answers *No, not at all* or *Sorry, I can't, because…* and offers another idea. Write who said yes.
- **Round 2 (6 min): Shift Switch Text (pairs).** Pairs write a 3-sentence text that confirms a shift switch (the day, the time, thanks). Then they read it to another pair. Remind them: "Ask your supervisor first."
- **15 learners:** a whole-room mingle for round 1; then pairs for round 2.
- **7–8 learners:** two lines face each other; move one place each round. Then pairs.
- **5 or fewer:** a circle for round 1: each person asks the person on the left. Then pairs (you join if there is an odd number).
- **Every answer needs a reason; every partner asks a follow-up.** Walk around and listen. Note 2 good sentences to praise and 1 common error for next week.
- **If behind:** round 1 only.

Step 6 · 7:15–7:25 · Read & Write: A building notice + a neighbor's note · 10 min

- **Grouping:** pairs read and answer; individual writing. With 5 or fewer, read the text aloud together.
- **Read (4 min):** Learners read the notice about packages and the note on the Read & Write page and answer the questions. Say: "Read fast first. Then find the answers." Pairs answer questions 1–5 together.
- **Check (1 min):** go over the answers (answer key).
- **Write (5 min):** Learners write a note to a neighbor (5–8 sentences) asking for a favor while they're away: the dates, what to do, where the key is, thanks, and an offer to help back. Show the example. Invented details are fine. Learners start in class and finish at home (Homework item 2).
- **If behind:** questions 1–5 only; the writing becomes homework.

Step 7 · 7:25–7:30 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket (3 min):** learners open the Exit Ticket page and answer in **3 sentences** with a reason: *Ask a classmate for a favor with* Would you mind…? **Example on the board: *Would you mind helping me with my homework? No, not at all. I'm asking because the last question is hard.*** **With 5 or fewer, a learner can say it to you first and then write it.**
- **Collect the pages.** After class, sort them into ✓ / almost / not yet. Start next week with 2 corrections on the board (no names).
- **Homework (2 min):** open the Homework page. Do item 1 together (item 1: *you / mind / feed / my cat? → Would you mind feeding my cat?*). Say: "About 15–20 minutes. Finish your Read & Write writing at home."

Listening script: L4_L5_listening.mp3 (about 1:54; the conversation plays once, so press play again for the second listen)

Audio: play L4_L5_listening.mp3 from a phone + small speaker. No speaker? Read the script with a volunteer, at a natural, friendly speed. The script says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*; learners only need to recognize those words.

Narrator: Lesson five. Patricia is going away for a week. First, she talks to her neighbor, Mr. Wilson.
Patricia: Hi, Mr. Wilson. Could I ask you a favor?
Mr. Wilson: Of course, Patricia. What is it?
Patricia: I'm going to be away next week. I'm visiting my sister. Would you mind getting my mail?
Mr. Wilson: No, not at all. I'm home all week.
Patricia: Thank you! And would you mind watering my plants? Just two times, on Tuesday and Friday.
Mr. Wilson: That is no problem. Where are you going to leave the key?
Patricia: I'm going to give you my spare key tonight. Oh, and would you mind feeding my cat, too?
Mr. Wilson: Sure, I'll do it. I love cats. Do you mind if I put your packages inside, too?
Patricia: No, go ahead. That's very kind.
Mr. Wilson: Have a good trip. Don't worry about anything.
Narrator: The next day at work, Patricia talks with Omar.
Omar: Hey, Patricia. Would you mind covering my Saturday shift? My son has a soccer game.
Patricia: Oh, I'm sorry, I can't. I'll be away on Saturday. I want to help, but I can't.
Omar: Oh, right. You told me.
Patricia: Why don't you ask Lena? She wants more hours this month.
Omar: Good idea. Do you mind if I tell her you suggested it?
Patricia: No, not at all. But ask the supervisor first, OK?
Omar: Sure. Thanks, Patricia. I owe you one.
Patricia: You're welcome. Good luck with the game!
Narrator: That's the end of the listening.

Answer key

- *Listening Task A:* **a** (get the mail, water the plants, feed the cat, and cover a shift).
- *Listening Task B:* 1 yes, 2 Tuesday and Friday, 3 her spare key, 4 inside, 5 no, 6 will be away.
- *Listening Task C:* 1 getting, 2 watering, 3 feeding, 4 if, 5 covering, 6 if.
- *Grammar Practice A:* 1 watering, 2 open, 3 feeding, 4 switching, 5 borrow, 6 getting.
- *Grammar Practice B:* 1 covering, 2 No, not at all., 3 leave, 4 mine, 5 'll be, 6 to switch.
- *Talk Time:* answers will vary.

- *Homework 1:* 1 Would you mind feeding my cat? 2 Do you mind if I leave early? 3 Would you mind covering my shift on Sunday? 4 No, not at all. *Homework 2 and 3:* answers will vary. *Homework 4:* 1 Why, 2 try, 3 to, 4 since, 5 for.
- *Read & Write B:* 1 To the new package room next to the mailroom. • 2 Within 5 days. • 3 Your text with the code. • 4 From June 10 to June 17. • 5 In an envelope under Ms. Lee's door (on Sunday). • *Writing (C):* answers will vary.
- *Exit ticket:* answers will vary. *A good answer:* "Would you mind helping me with my homework? No, not at all. I'm asking because the last question is hard."

Teacher notes

- **No = yes:** practice the answer first, with a thumbs-up: *No, not at all!* Learners often say *Yes* and mean "I'll help." Smile and model it again.
- **Invented details:** all favor cards, keys, names, and addresses are invented. Learners never share real addresses or where they keep a key.
- **Shift switches:** every employer has its own rules. Add "Ask your supervisor first." It is printed on the Shift Switch Text page.
- ***mind* + -ing:** *Would you mind getting…?* But *Do you mind if I* + the base verb: *Do you mind if I leave…?*
- **Saying no:** model *sorry + a reason + another idea*. A polite no is a good answer.
- **Spanish and other languages:** the contrast tip on the Grammar page is optional. Learners read it on their own. You never need to read, translate, or explain it.
- **Reductions:** the listening says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*. Learners only need to recognize the short forms; they can always say the full forms.

STUDENT WORKBOOK

Lesson 5 (Week 5)

Would You Mind…?

Opening Talk · New Words · Listening · Grammar · Talk Time · Homework · Read & Write · Exit Ticket

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Opening Talk

Name: _____ Date: _____

Work with a partner. A asks a question. B answers in 3 sentences: the answer, a reason, and a detail. A asks one follow-up question. Then switch.

A: I sit all day at work. Any ideas?	**A:** I'm always tired in the afternoon. What can I do?
A: What's a good idea for a healthy lunch?	**A:** How often is it a good idea to get a checkup?

Follow-ups: **Why? • Have you ever tried it? • How long have you…?**

Write your partner's name and one good idea from Homework item 3.

My partner's name	A good idea (*It's a good idea to…*)

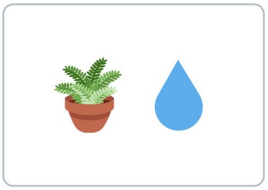
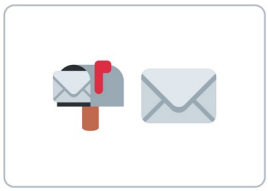
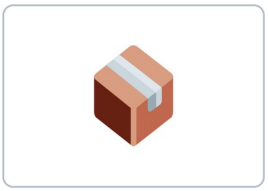
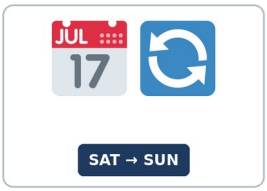
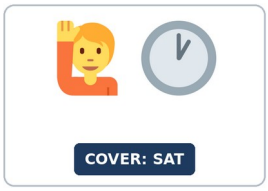
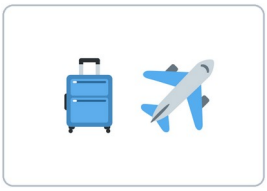
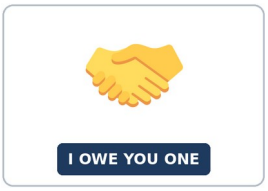
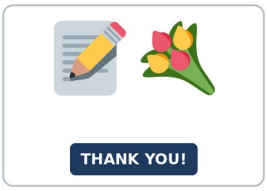
Lesson 5 (Week 5): Would You Mind…?

Student Page 1 · Week 5

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **favor**	 ★ **borrow**	 ★ **water the plants**	 ★ **feed the cat**
 ★ **get the mail**	 ★ **spare key**	 ★ **package**	 ★ **switch shifts**
 ★ **cover a shift**	 ★ **be away**	 **owe (someone)**	 **thank-you note**

Partner game: Favor or no favor?

Example: A points to a picture and asks, "Would you mind **getting the mail**?" B gives a thumbs-up and says, "No, not at all," or says, "Sorry, I can't, because…" Switch.

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · My Words

My personal word list. Write each word in your language, if you want. Then write your own example.

Word	My language	My example
favor		
borrow		
water the plants		
feed the cat		
get the mail		
spare key		
package		
switch shifts		
cover a shift		
be away		
owe (someone)		
thank-you note		

Add 2 more words from tonight (from the listening, the reading, or your partner).

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Listening

Patricia is going away for a week. First, she asks her older neighbor, Mr. Wilson, for some favors. The next day at work, her coworker Omar asks her for a favor.

A. Listen. What favors do they ask for? Circle.

a. get the mail, water the plants, feed the cat, and cover a shift **b.** borrow a ladder and switch shifts **c.** pick up a package and lend a car

B. Listen again. Yes or no, and why? Circle the answer.

1. The mail: Mr. Wilson says (**yes** / **no**).
2. The plants: water them on (**Tuesday and Friday** / **Monday and Thursday**).
3. The key: Patricia will give him (**her spare key** / **her car key**) tonight.
4. The packages: Mr. Wilson can put them (**inside** / **at the office**).
5. The Saturday shift: Patricia says (**yes** / **no**).
6. Why? She (**will be away** / **has a soccer game**).

C. Listen again. Write the missing word: an *-ing* word or *if*.

1. Would you mind _____ my mail?
2. And would you mind _____ my plants?
3. Oh, and would you mind _____ my cat, too?
4. Do you mind _____ I put your packages inside, too?
5. Would you mind _____ my Saturday shift?
6. Do you mind _____ I tell her you suggested it?

Hear it, say it

gonna = going to: "I'm **going to** be away next week." • *wanna* = want to: "I **want to** help, but I can't." You can say *going to* and *want to*. Say *Would you mind…?* and *Do you mind if I…?* smoothly, with a friendly rise at the end. Answer with a thumbs-up: *No, not at all!*

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Grammar

Read across. A reads from the left side. B answers from the right side. Choose one part from each column.

Grammar Box 1: *Would you mind + -ing?*

QUESTION		ANSWER	
Would you mind	**getting** my mail?	No, **not at all**.	**I'll** do it.
Would you mind	**covering** my shift?	**Sorry**, I **can't**.	I'll be away too.
Would you mind	**lending** me a ladder?	No, **not at all**.	I'm free on Saturday.
		No problem.	You can borrow **mine**.

Grammar Box 2: permission: *Do you mind if I…?*

QUESTION		ANSWER	
Do you mind if I	**open** the window?	No, **go ahead**.	It's hot in here.
Do you mind if I	**leave** early today?	**Sorry**,	we need you until 5:00.
Do you mind if I	**switch** my Friday shift?	No, **not at all**.	Ask the supervisor first.

Rule of thumb: After ***Would you mind***, use **-ing** (*getting, covering*). After ***Do you mind if I***, use the base verb (*open, leave*). The answer **No** means "No problem. I'll help." / "Yes, you can."

Grammar Box 3: saying yes, saying no

YOU CAN HELP (say *no*!)	YOU CAN'T HELP (be polite)
No, not at all. • *No problem.* • *Sure, I'll do it.*	*Sorry, I can't, because…* + another idea: *Why don't you ask Lena?*

Grammar Box 4: how polite?

	WHEN?	EXAMPLE
Can you…?	a small favor, a friend	*Can you pass the salt?*
Could you…?	more polite	*Could you help me with this box?*
Would you mind …ing?	the most polite; a **bigger** favor	*Would you mind feeding my cat for a week?*

Questions and answers

Q: Someone asks *Would you mind helping me?* I want to help. Do I say *yes*?

A: No! Say ***No, not at all.*** *Mind* asks "Is it a problem?" *No* = no problem.

Q: *Would you mind to get* or *Would you mind getting*?

A: After *mind*, use *-ing*: ***Would you mind getting my mail?***

Q: How do I say no politely?

A: Say sorry, give a reason, and offer an idea: ***Sorry, I can't. I'll be away. Why don't you ask Lena?***

Practice A: Write the correct form of the verb.

1. Would you mind _____ my plants? (water)
2. Do you mind if I _____ the window? (open)
3. Would you mind _____ the cat on Sunday? (feed)
4. Would you mind _____ shifts with me? (switch)
5. Do you mind if I _____ your ladder? (borrow)
6. Would you mind _____ my packages? (get)

Practice B: Circle the correct words.

1. Would you mind (**covering** / **to cover**) my shift?
2. A: Would you mind helping me? B: (**No, not at all.** / **Yes, I do.**) I'll help.
3. Do you mind if I (**leave** / **leaving**) early?
4. Could I borrow your pen? I forgot (**mine** / **my**).
5. Sorry, I can't. I (**'ll be** / **be**) away.
6. I'd like (**to switch** / **switching**) my Friday shift.

Common mistakes

✕ Don't say	✓ Say
Would you mind to get my mail?	Would you mind **getting** my mail?
Yes, I mind. I'll help you.	**No, not at all.** I'll help you.
Do you mind if I using your phone?	Do you mind if I **use** your phone?
Can I borrow your?	Can I borrow **yours**?
I like to switch my shift.	I'**d** like to switch my shift.

> **Contrast tip (optional):** In many languages, a *yes* answer means "I'll help." But *Would you mind…?* asks "Is it a problem for you?", so in English **No** means "No problem." Spanish *¿Te importaría…? No, para nada* works the same way. What does your language do?

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Talk Time: Favor Exchange

Round 1. Take a favor card and a "my week" card. Ask three people for your favor. Answer *No, not at all* or *Sorry, I can't, because…* and offer another idea. Write who said yes.

FAVOR CARDS (invented)	
1. get my mail for a week	2. switch my Saturday shift
3. lend me a ladder on Sunday	4. water my plants on Friday
5. feed my cat this weekend	6. cover my Monday shift
7. pick up my package today	8. drive me to work on Tuesday

MY WEEK CARD	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Card A	free	busy	free	free	busy	away	away
Card B	busy	free	free	busy	free	free	busy

Example: A: Would you mind getting my mail next week? B: No, not at all. I'm home all week. C: Sorry, I can't, because I'll be away. Why don't you ask Ana?

I asked…	Yes or no?	Their reason or idea
1.		
2.		
3.		

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Talk Time: Shift Switch Text

Round 2. Work with a partner. Write a 3-sentence text to a coworker. Confirm the shift switch: the day, the time, and thanks. Then read it to another pair.

Example: "Hi, Omar. Thanks for switching shifts with me! I'll work your Sunday shift (9:00–5:00), and you'll work my Friday shift (2:00–10:00). I've told Ms. Diaz, and she says it's OK."

Our text

CHECK: does your text have…?	✔
the day and the time	☐
who works which shift	☐
thanks	☐

Useful: Thanks for… • I'll work your… • You'll work my… • I've told the supervisor. • See you on…

Remember: every job has its own rules. Ask your supervisor first.

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Homework

Homework (about 15–20 minutes). Bring it next week!

1. Write the question or answer. Use the words.

Example: you / mind / get / my mail? → *Would you mind getting my mail?*

1. you / mind / feed / my cat? → _____
2. do you mind if I / leave / early? →

   _____
3. you / mind / cover / my shift / on Sunday? →

   _____
4. a "yes, I'll help" answer: no / not / all →

   _____

2. Finish your writing from Read & Write C (your note). Read it one more time. Check ✓ the list in D.

☐ I finished it. ☐ I checked it with the list.

3. Write 3 favors you could ask a neighbor or a coworker. Then write a polite answer for each one.

My favor (*Would you mind…?*)	A polite answer
1.	
2.	
3.	

4. Review (Lesson 4). Write one word.

1. _____ don't you call the clinic?
2. You could _____ a heating pad.
3. It's a good idea _____ get a flu shot every year.
4. I've had a cough _____ Sunday.
5. She's had a rash _____ three days.

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Read & Write

A. Read the notice. *Read fast first. Then read again and answer the questions.*

NOTICE · Maple Court Apartments + a note to a neighbor

NOTICE: Packages. Starting June 1, all packages will go to the new package room next to the mailroom. You will get a text with a code when a package arrives. Please pick up your packages within 5 days. If you are going to be away, you can ask a neighbor to pick them up for you. Your neighbor must show your text with the code. Questions? Call the office at (555) 210-4400.

A NOTE on the door of apartment 3B:

Hi, Ms. Lee! This is Tomás from 3A. I'm going to be away from June 10 to June 17. Would you mind picking up my packages from the package room? I'll text you the codes. Also, would you mind feeding my cat, Luna, in the evening? Her food is in the kitchen. My spare key will be in an envelope under your door on Sunday. Thank you so much! I owe you one. If you ever need help, just ask. Tomás

B. Answer the questions.

1. Where will all packages go? _____
2. When must you pick up a package?

   _____
3. What must a neighbor show? _____
4. When will Tomás be away? _____
5. Where will the spare key be? _____

C. Write a note to a neighbor (5–8 sentences). Ask for a favor while you're away: the dates, what to do, where the key is, thanks, and an offer to help back.

Example: Hi, Mr. Ruiz! I'm going to be away from May 3 to May 8. Would you mind getting my mail? Also, would you mind watering my plants on Wednesday? My spare key will be under your door on Friday. Thank you so much! If you ever need help, just ask. Ana (2C)

My note

D. Check your writing with a partner.

	Yes	Not yet
It has 5–8 sentences.	☐	☐
It has the dates.	☐	☐
It has *Would you mind…?* + *-ing*.	☐	☐
It has thanks and an offer to help back.	☐	☐

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Exit Ticket

Name: _____ Date: _____

Answer in 3 sentences. Give a reason. Then give this page to your teacher.

Ask a classmate for a favor with *Would you mind…?*

Sentence 1: your question (*Would you mind…?*) • *Sentence 2:* their answer • *Sentence 3:* the reason, with *because*

My answer
1.
2.
3.

For the teacher	✓	almost	not yet
3 sentences, today's grammar, a reason	☐	☐	☐

Lesson 5 (Week 5) · Task Words (optional)

This page is for you if you want it. You can skip it. Write each task word in your language, if you want.

Task word	What you do	My language
Listen.	Use your ears. Don't write yet.	
Circle.	Draw a circle around the answer.	
Check ✓.	Make a ✓ in the box.	
Write.	Write words or sentences.	
Number.	Write 1, 2, 3… to show the order.	
Match.	Find the two parts that go together.	
Work with a partner.	Work with one classmate.	
Work in a group.	Work with 2 or 3 classmates.	
Switch.	Change roles: A is B now.	
Ask a follow-up question.	Ask one more question about the answer.	
Give a reason.	Say why, with *because* or *so*.	
Compare.	Look at your partner's answers. Are they the same?	

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